MITTEN MAGIC
FOR ANY KNITTING MACHINE

Any Yarn – Any Gauge



Sue Jalowiec | Knit it Now, LLC

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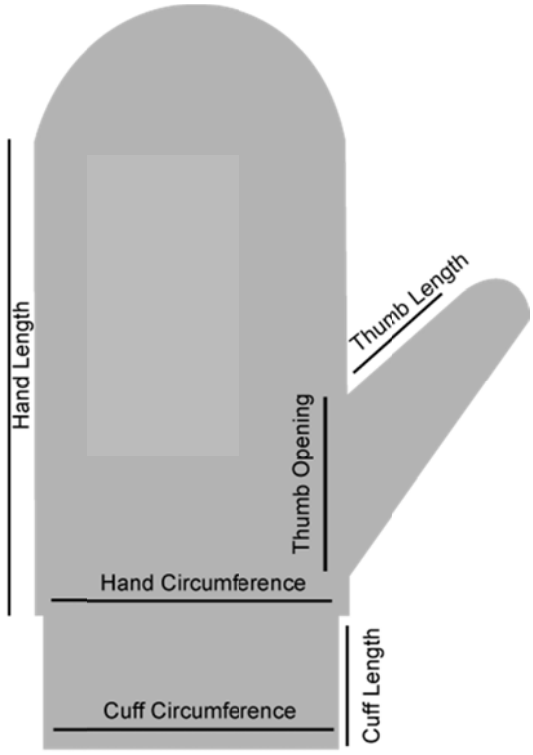
BONUS FELTED MITTENS 36

Addendum:

- Mitten Template
- Block Alphabet Charts
- Scaled Knitters Graph Paper

SIZING CHART

Any size, any gauge pattern on page 31



	2-4 years	4-6 years	6-8 years	Child Large Woman Small	Woman Medium	Woman Large Man Small	Man Medium	Man Large
Cuff Circumference	5”	5.5”	6”	6.5”	7”	7.5”	8”	8.5”
Cuff Length	1.75	2.25	2.5	2.5	2.75	2.75	3	3
Hand Circumference	5.5	6	6.5	7	7.5	8	8.5	9
Hand Length	4	4.75	5.25	6	6.5	7.25	7.75	8.5
Thumb Length	.75	1	1.25	1.25	1.5	1.75	2	2
Thumb Opening	1.75	2	2.25	2.25	2.5	2.75	3	3.25
Top Shaping	1	1.25	1.25	1.5	1.5	1.75	1.75	2

Machine Knit Mittens for Fun and Profit



Knitting mittens on the machine is not hard and with practice can be fast! In a single knitting session, you can proudly say "look what I made!"

- Warm hands in your community
- Knit mittens for your family
- Use them as a canvas for your creativity
- Make money selling them online or at craft fairs.

Because they are knit flat, machine knit mittens have seams to finish, but they are much faster than hand knitting them in the round.

With this book, you can use any yarn and any knitting machine. You don't need fancy electronics or even punchcards. Having a ribber is nice, but not essential. If you don't have a ribber and want ribbed cuffs, you'll need to know how to hand knit ribbing.

What you need to know:	What you will learn:
Set up your machine and knit a basic swatch	Knit and measure a proper gauge swatch
Be familiar with the appropriate yarns for your machine	Simple math to chart your own mitten
Set your machine to hold position (check your manual)	Combine hand knitting with machine knitting
How to cast on and knit plain stockinette	Cuff options
Loose bind off method	Inserting a gored thumb with no sewing
	Invisible Kitchener stitch seam
	No-bulk Bickford Seam
	Gather technique
	Knitting Stripes (and dealing with the ends)
	Embellishment inspiration
	And much more!

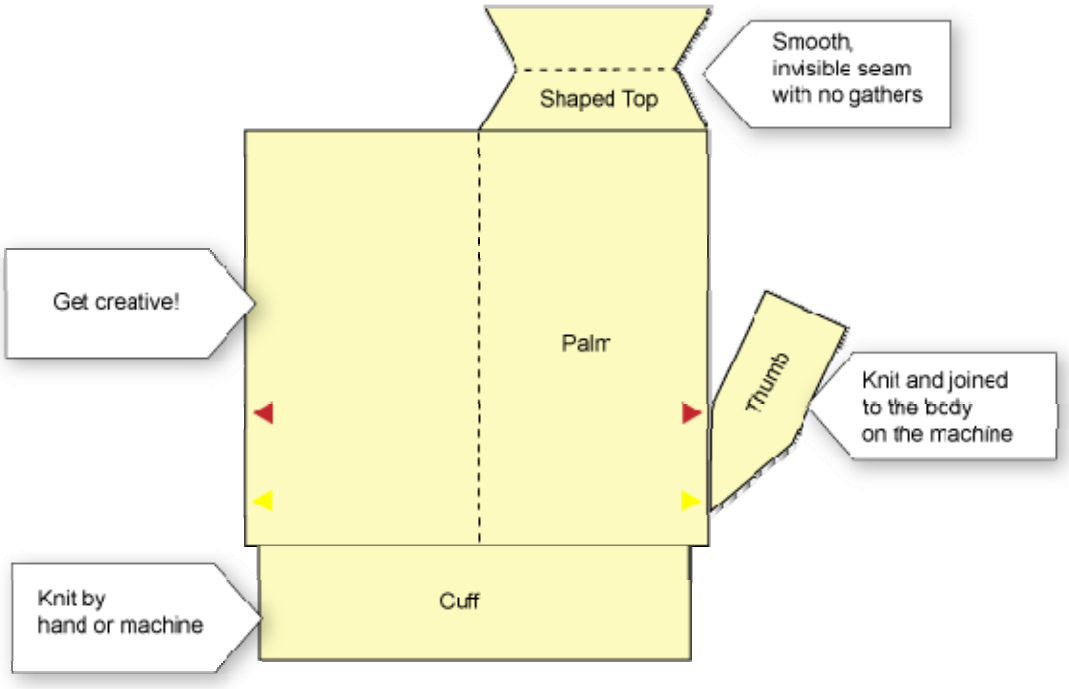
Pull up a seat, read through the basic overview of knitting the mitten and you be knitting in no time!

You will write your own pattern based on your stitch and row gauge. Don't worry! There are only 7 numbers to calculate. I bet you could even work the math in your head (although using a calculator is allowed).

BASIC MITTEN OVERVIEW

A basic flat mitten on the machine is knit in this order:

1. Cuff
2. Front and back of hand
3. Shaped Top
4. Thumb
5. Finishing



CUFF

NOTE: Plan head for a beautiful cuff seam – See "Plan Ahead" on page 24

CUFFS BY HAND

Knit your ribbed cuffs by hand. Choose k1, p1 ribbing or any ribbing design of your choice. The purpose of the cuff is to keep the mitten snug around the wrist and keep out the winter chill.

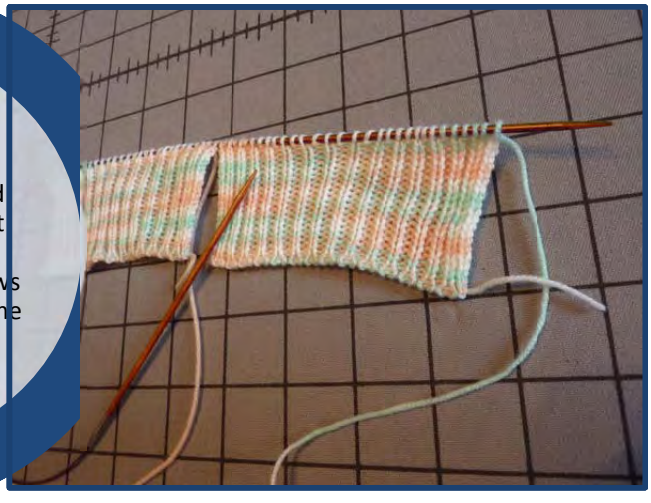
Knit the cuff extra long so it can be doubled for extra warmth.



In the top example, half the cuff was worked in k2, p2 rib, and half was worked in p2,k2 rib. This provides a fold line and the doubled cuff lays flat.

Tip:

Use 2 balls of yarn and hand knit both cuffs at the same time. You won't have to count rows to make sure they are the same length



If you knit your ribbing by hand, when you are ready to knit the mitten on the machine, transfer the stitches from your knitting needle to the machine needles and you are ready to go!





Hand knit cuff in the round.

Start your mitten with waste yarn and ravel cord.

After mitten is completed, pick up stitches from waste yarn on double pointed needles.

Knit desired length of cuff.

Bind off

CUFFS BY MACHINE WITH A RIBBER

For really fast mittens, use your ribber to create your cuffs. Check your machine manual for various needle set up possibilities. (1 X 1, 2 X 2, 2 X 3 etc).

As in hand knitting, the purpose is a tight, warm cuff around the wrist.

TIP:

For a quick ribber cast on:

1. On the main bed only, cast on with waste yarn and ravel cord.
2. Work a chain cast on loosely over the same needles.
3. Transfer every other needle to the ribber bed.
4. Hang ribber comb.
5. Knit your ribbing.



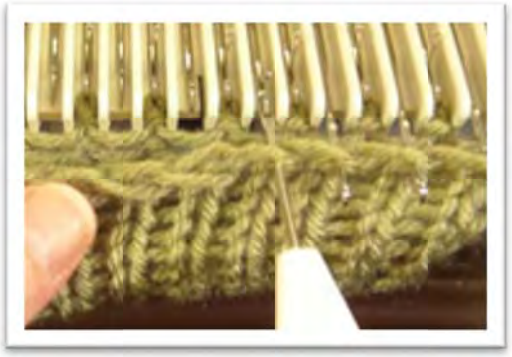
When the ribbing is complete, transfer all stitches to the main bed and continue knitting in the stitch pattern of your choice

CUFFS BY MACHINE WITHOUT A RIBBER

MOCK RIBBING ON THE MACHINE

1. Pull out the number of needles indicated in your pattern.
2. Cast on every other needle with a loose, closed cast on (e-wrap cast on is stretchy and works well.
3. **Put the empty needles in out of work position.**
4. Knit twice the number of cuff rows as instructed.
5. Hang a hem by hanging loops from the cast on edge, on the empty needles forming a hem.
6. Knit across all needles and continue knitting the mitten.
7. When the knitting for the mitten is complete, insert a pencil in the fold of the hem and give it a tug to set the stitches.
8. This gives stretch and the appearance of ribbing without any purl stitches.



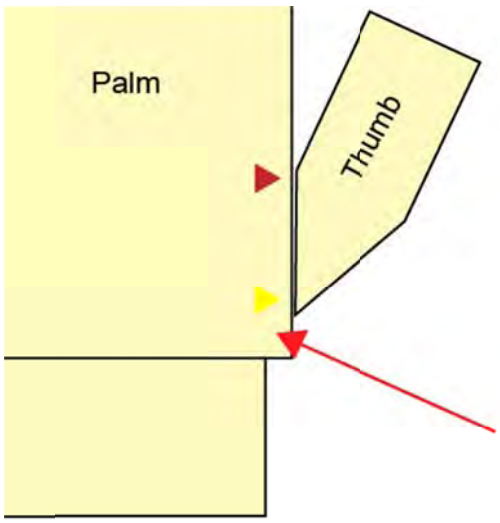






MITTEN INSET FOR COMFORT

For great fit, this pattern includes a small section between the cuff and the beginning of the thumb.



Work the hand in any stitch pattern of your choice! Be sure to swatch the stitch pattern to obtain accurate stitch and row gauge

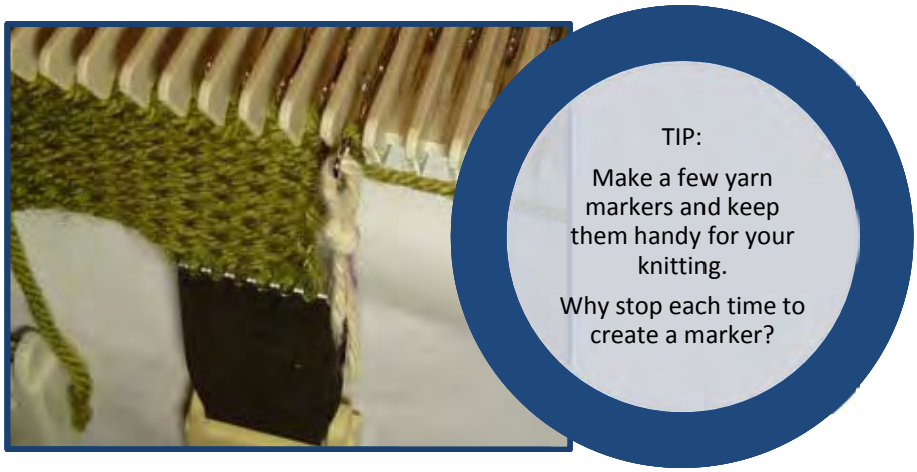
THUMB OPENING

No shaping is done in this area (the gore shaping is worked with the thumb).

Use yarn markers on each side of your knitting to indicate the start and end of the thumb opening.

- Cut a 3-4” piece of contrasting color yarn
- Make a slip knot
- Hang the loop on the edge needle.
- This strand will be worked into your next row of knitting and can be cut and removed later.

For your first few mittens, to make things clear, use a different color for the start and end markers, like the yellow and red arrows on the diagram.



MITTEN HAND

Use the plain knitting section of the mitten as a canvas for your creativity!

With no shaping in this section, the sky is the limit!

Stripes are the easiest to work, but working in the ends can discourage you from finishing your mittens.

Work in the ends as you knit. Just wrap the yarn end over and under every other needle on following rows. The end will be knit in and will stay put! Guaranteed!

When it comes time to seam the mitten edges, you can concentrate on matching your stripes instead of worrying about ends.



Check out "Embellishments" on page 29 for more inspiration for the hand section of your mittens.



Use the "To Scale" graph paper included with this book to design your own mittens.



MITTEN TOP

Shape the top of the mitten with short rows. If you've never used this technique, don't worry! If you can set your machine to hold, you can short row. Follow these instructions step-by-step.

Following your pattern, put ½ of the mitten stitches in holding position and set your machine to hold.

You will be working on only ½ the stitches.

Shortrow Decrease:

- On the carriage side, put 1 stitch in hold position and knit across (automatic wrap)
- Knit across
- Again, on the carriage side put 1 stitch in hold position.
- Knit across
- Continue decreasing as instructed in your pattern.



Shortrow Increase:

- On the side opposite the carriage, put one needle back in working position
- Knit across
- Again, on the side opposite the carriage, put one needle back in working position
- Knit across
- Continue until all needles are in work.

Remove all mitten stitches on waste yarn.



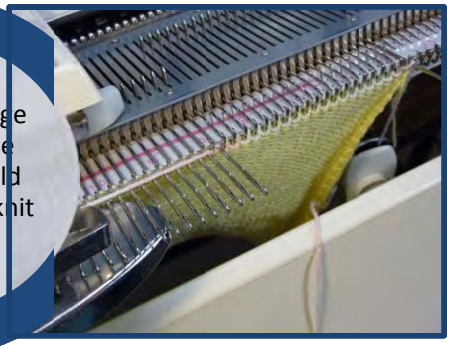
Use a contrasting color for the top of the mitten for fun! (and use up bits of leftover yarn)

SHORTROW DECREASE



Set machine to hold, pull 1/2 needles to hold position

On the carriage side, pull one needle to hold position and knit across



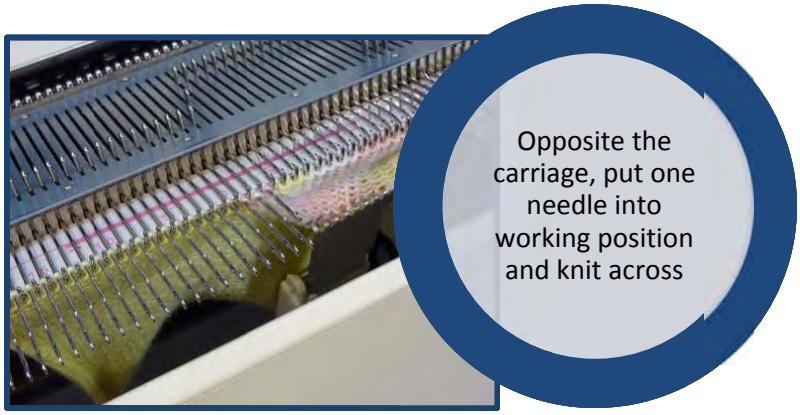


Continue as instructed, pulling needle on the carriage side into hold position

Add weight as the pocket forms



SHORTROW INCREASE







FORM THE MITTEN TOP



Use the waste knitting as a guide and Kitchener stitch the seam

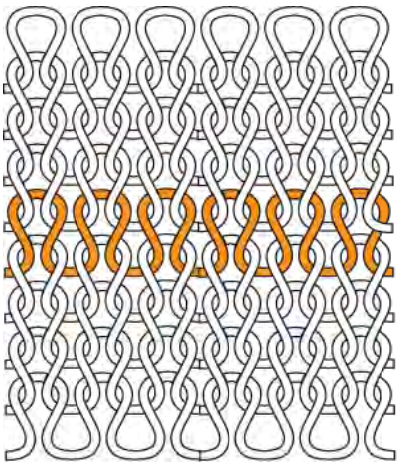
Drop the work from the machine



KITCHENER STITCH ON THE MACHINE

Because it is knit flat, this style of mitten requires an invisible seam to join the top of the mitten to the hand. This is accomplished with Kitchener stitch.

Using a strand of yarn and a darning needle, you will form a row of stitches, joining the edges. A contrasting color yarn was used in these examples for clarity



- With wrong sides facing, on the machine, rehang the stitches on waste yarn wrong. (2 stitches on each needle)
- Use the tail of yarn and work Kitchener Stitch joining the 2 edges.
- Keep the tension of your joining yarn even, mimicking the knitted stitches
- With practice you will be able to stitch an invisible seam.



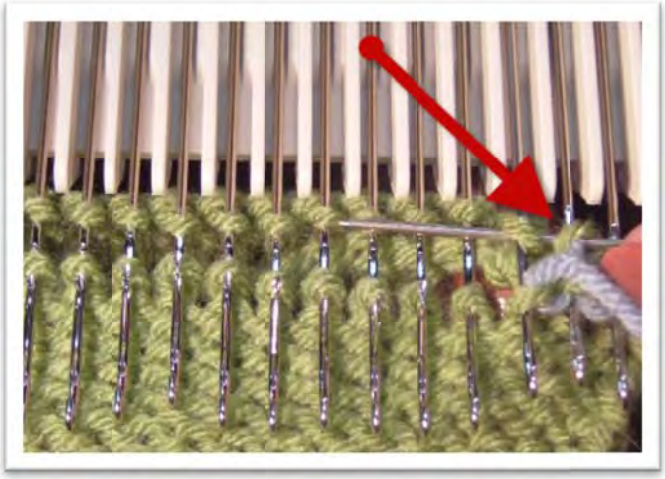


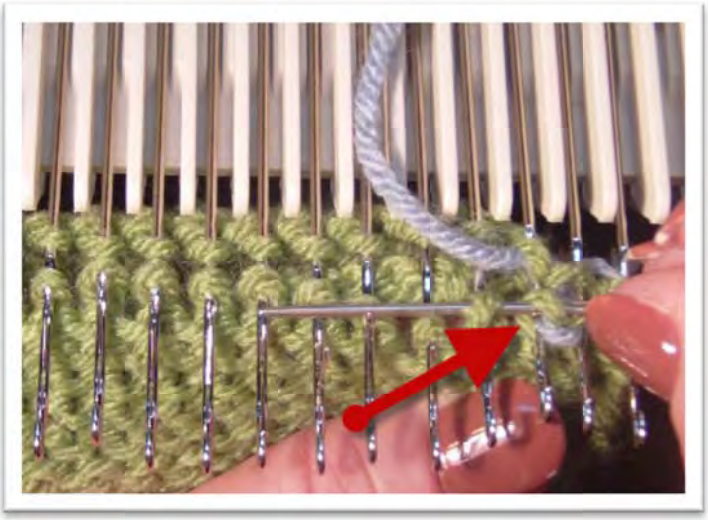
Working from right to left:

Insert the needle through 2 stitches on in the back

Notice that the 2 stitches form a “smile” on the darning needle

Pull the yarn through these 2 stitches, leaving them in place on the machine needles.





Now insert the darning needle in the next 2 stitches on in front.

Notice that the stitches form a “frown” on the darning needle

Pull the yarn through these 2 stitches, leaving them in place on the machine needles.



Repeat across the work, alternating between the front stitches and the back stitches. making sure that the joining yarn goes through each stitch twice.

Back stitches

> “Smile” through the previous stitch and the next new stitch.

Front Stitches

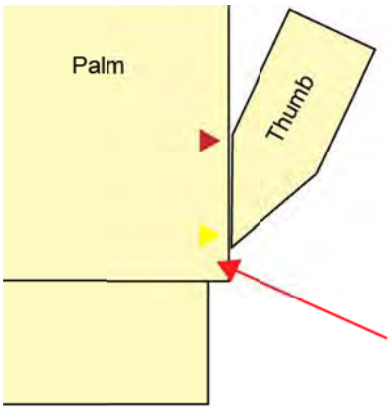
> “Frown” through the previous stitch and the next new stitch

When you complete the row, remove everything from the machine and you will have a neatly joined, invisible row of knitting.

GORE THUMB

The following technique will insert and shape the thumb gore, plus join the sides of the mitten at the same time, with no seam to hand sew!

Locate the yarn markers on either side of the mitten. Fold the mitten in half, right (public) sides together, matching the yellow markers nearest the cuff.





Hang the edge stitch from one marker row (nearest the cuff) on the needle bed. Hang the matching edge stitch from the other side of the mitten on the SAME NEEDLE. (This will provide a seaming stitch to neatly finish the mitten seam)



Continue hanging the edge stitches from the thumb opening on each side of the needle bed.

Pick up the stitches along the both sides of the thumb opening.

Remember: You are picking up stitches to rows. Hang approximately 2 stitches for every 3 rows



Put all the needles in hold position and set the machine to hold

Close the latches (this helps knit the stitches more cleanly, especially with thick yarn)

Use a business card or piece of paper to close the latches, run a finger along the closed latches to ensure they stay closed.



Put the center 3 needles into working position and knit across.

Wrap the tail of yarn and secure with a clothes pin or chip clip.



To shape the gore, work short row increases:

Opposite the carriage, put a needle into working position and knit across.

Continue increasing until all needles are in working position.



Continue knitting the thumb with no shaping according to your pattern.

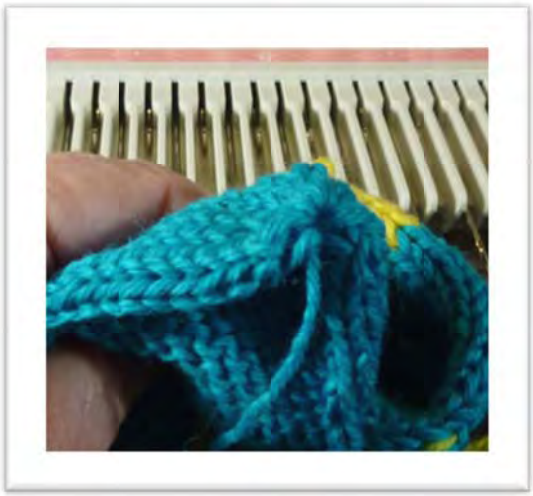


Break the yarn and thread the tail in a darning needle.

Run the tail through the stitches, removing the work from the machine at the same time.

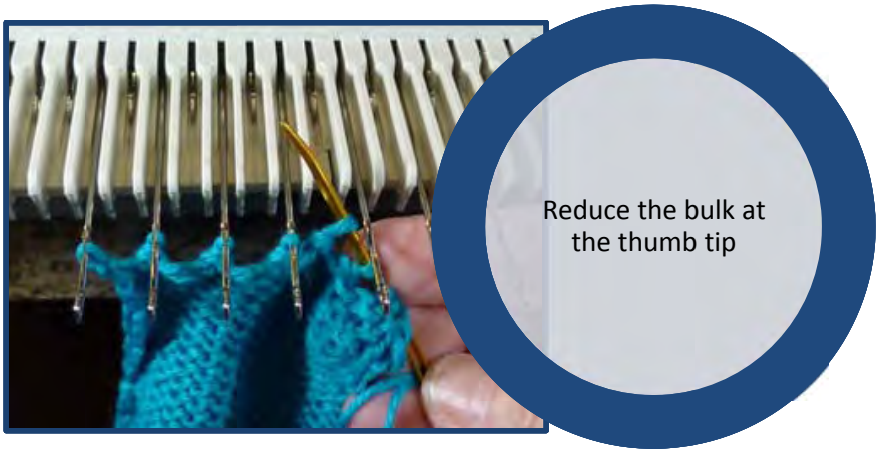
Pull the tail tight.

Secure with a stitch and use the tail to seam the thumb.



TIP:

1. To reduce bulk at the thumb tip.
2. Knit 2 less rows than instructed.
3. End with the carriage on the left.
4. Transfer every other stitch to its neighboring needle.
5. Knit 1 row at a tighter tension from left to right
6. Break the yarn and thread the tail in a darning needle.
7. Run the tail through the stitches, removing the work from the machine at the same time.
8. Pull the tail tight.
9. Secure with a stitch and use the tail to seam the thumb.



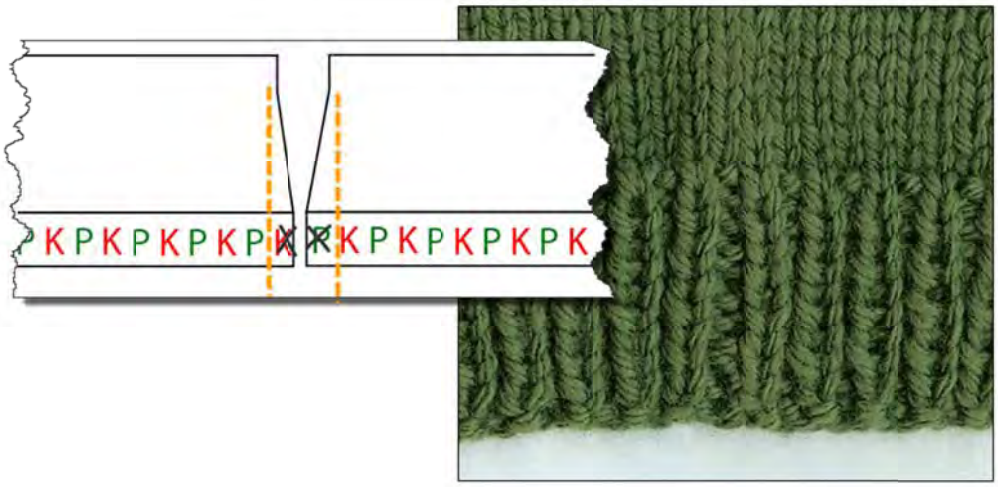
FINISHING

PLAN-AHEAD RIBBING

When seaming ribbed pieces, it is important that you plan ahead. A little planning will ensure that your seams match and are picture perfect every time!

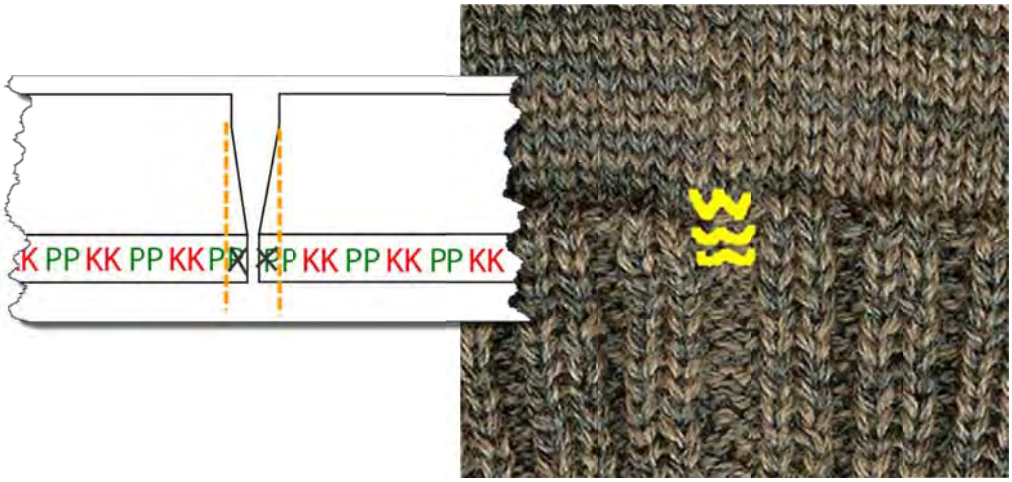
When you cast on your ribbing, consider the arrangement of knit and purl stitches.

For example, 1 x 1 (k1,p1) ribbing is worked over an even number of stitches. If you cast on an even number of stitches and take a full stitch on each side for your seam, you will end up with a nearly invisible seam



2 x 2 ribbing (k2, p2)

For an invisible seam, plan to have 2 knit stitches on each edge or 2 purl stitches on each edge. You may have to adjust the pattern cast on instructions.(multiple of 4) it!



TURNED BACK CUFF

If you are planning a turned back cuff, don't forget to hide the seam.

Seam ½ the cuff with the "right side" facing and ½ the cuff with the "wrong side" facing, ensuring the seam is hidden when the cuff is folded back.



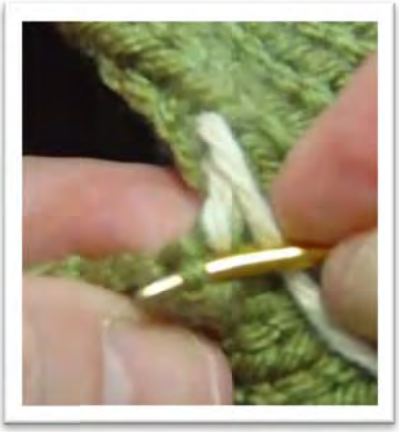


What a difference a little planning makes … no ugly seam on the public side of the folded cuff!

SEAMING

MATTRESS STITCH

Use the traditional mattress stitch technique to join the mitten seam. Pick up ½ or 1 full stitch on each edge to join.



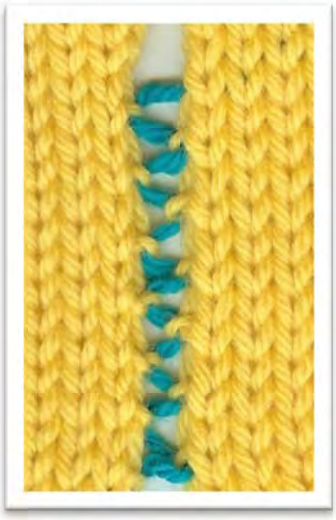


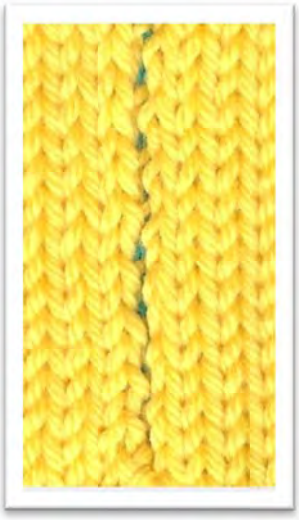
Done neatly, mattress stitch produces a nearly invisible seam

BICKFORD SEAM

A Bickford Seam is a great technique to eliminate bulk in the seam.

Weave your seaming yarn between the knots on each edge and pull tight. The resulting seam is flat and nearly invisible (when worked with the garment yarn)





SEAMING ON THE MACHINE

To eliminate hand seaming, re-hang the edges of the mitten on the machine to seam:

1. Re-hang each edge on the needles





2. Knit 1 row at mitten tension from left to right
3. Knit 1 loose row from right to left



4. Bind off loosely by pulling stitch through stitch
5. Secure the last stitch with the tail



Although fast to work, this technique adds a “chain” to secure the seam. With heavier yarns, and for small size mittens you may not want the extra bulk.

EMBELLISHMENTS AND TIPS

Embellishments



- Applique – use left over felted pieces to craft flowers, leaves or other shapes
- Buttons – add an assortment of buttons to decorate the hand of a mitten
- Fairisle –work small fairisle (stranded colorwork). Be careful to use designs with small floats so fingers don't catch
- Duplicate stitch (Swiss Darning) – the sky is the limit!
    - Initials (Block Alphabet is included in this book)
    - Snowflakes
    - Numbers
    - Geometric shapes
    - Use the following knitters grid to sketch your ideas
- Cuffs – Multicolor cuffs, ruffled cuffs, Incorporate unique ribbing techniques
- Cables
    - Use the included knitters grid to sketch cables – don't forget cables tend to shrink up, so you may need to cast on a few more stitches. For intricate, allover cables, be sure to swatch using your cable pattern
- Stripes, Stripes, Stripes!
    - Use your imagination (and your scraps of leftover yarn)
- Drawstring
    - Work a long i-cord and attach it to each mitten, run the cord through the sleeves of a child's winter jacket. Less chance for lost mittens
    - Clip each mitten to the sleeve edge of a childs coat with suspender clips
    - Knit 3 mittens for kids … if one gets lost … you have a spare!
- Squirmy babies are hard to dress … knit thumb-less mittens for the little ones





SWATCHING IS NOT OPTIONAL

No matter what method you use to create a swatch, you need to determine YOUR gauge. Not the gauge from the ball band, website or a friend … YOUR gauge!

Yes, even for mittens! Without an accurate gauge measurement, the mitten designed for yourself may fit your child!

Knit a swatch AT LEAST 5" square (you can always re-use the yarn)



Here's a suggested swatch for a standard gauge machine

- Cast on 60 stitches (needle 30 left – 30 right)
- Knit a 10 rows in your stitch pattern
- Switch to a contrasting yarn and knit 2 rows plain
- Change to your main yarn and your stitch pattern
- Knit 20 rows
- Hand knit in a yarn marker on needle 21 left and 21 right (isolating 40 stitches between markers)
- Knit 20 rows
- Hang another set of markers
- Knit 20 rows
- Switch to contrasting yarn and knit 2 rows plain
- Change to your main yarn and stitch pattern and knit 10 rows
- Bind off



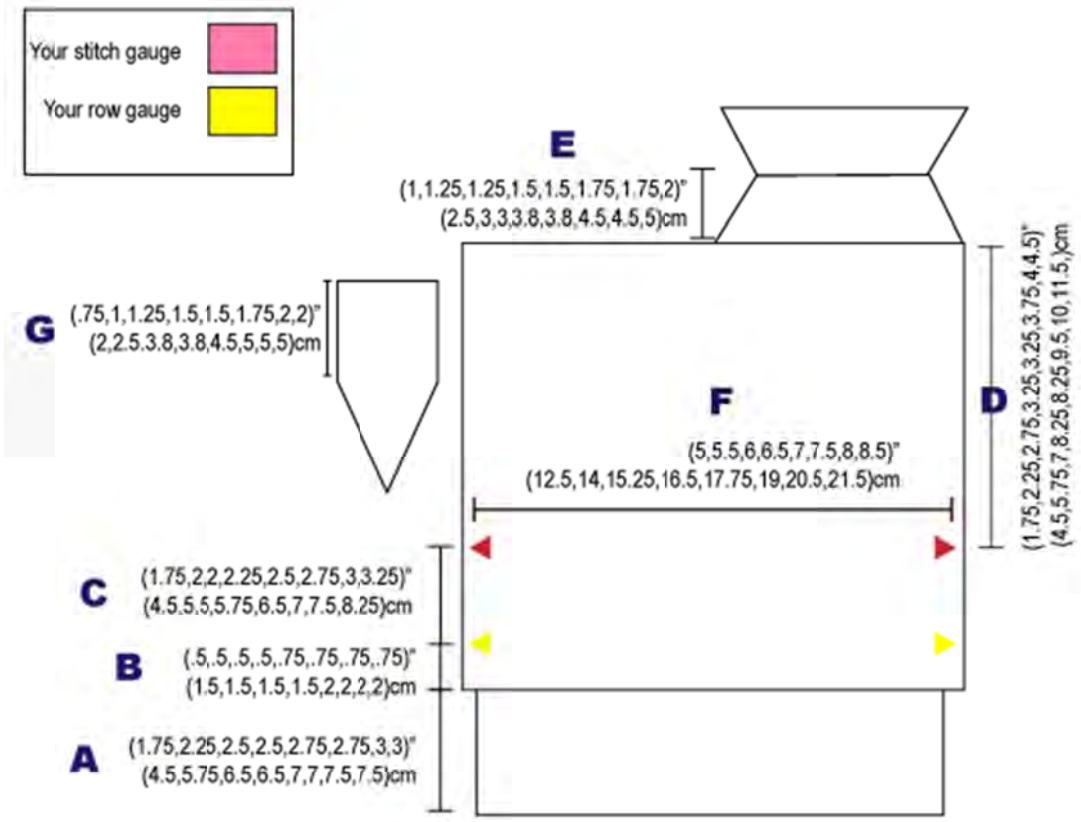
* * * * * *

- Do not measure the swatch right off the machine, it needs to rest.
- Dress the swatch (wash, dry and block using the same methods you will treat your mittens)
- Measure the stitches between the makers
- Divide the number of stitches between the markers (40) by the measurement to determine your stitches per inch (example 40/5.75" = 6.96 stitches per inch)
- Measure the rows between the contrasting rows
- Divide the number of rows between contrasting rows (60) by the measurement to determine your rows per inch (example 60/4.5" = 13.34 rows per inch)

Use YOUR numbers to fill in the following worksheets for your mitten.

MITTEN PATTERN

SIMPLE MATH



[F x] _____ Stitches

[A x] _____ Rows

[B x] _____ Rows

[C x] _____ Rows

[D x] _____ Rows

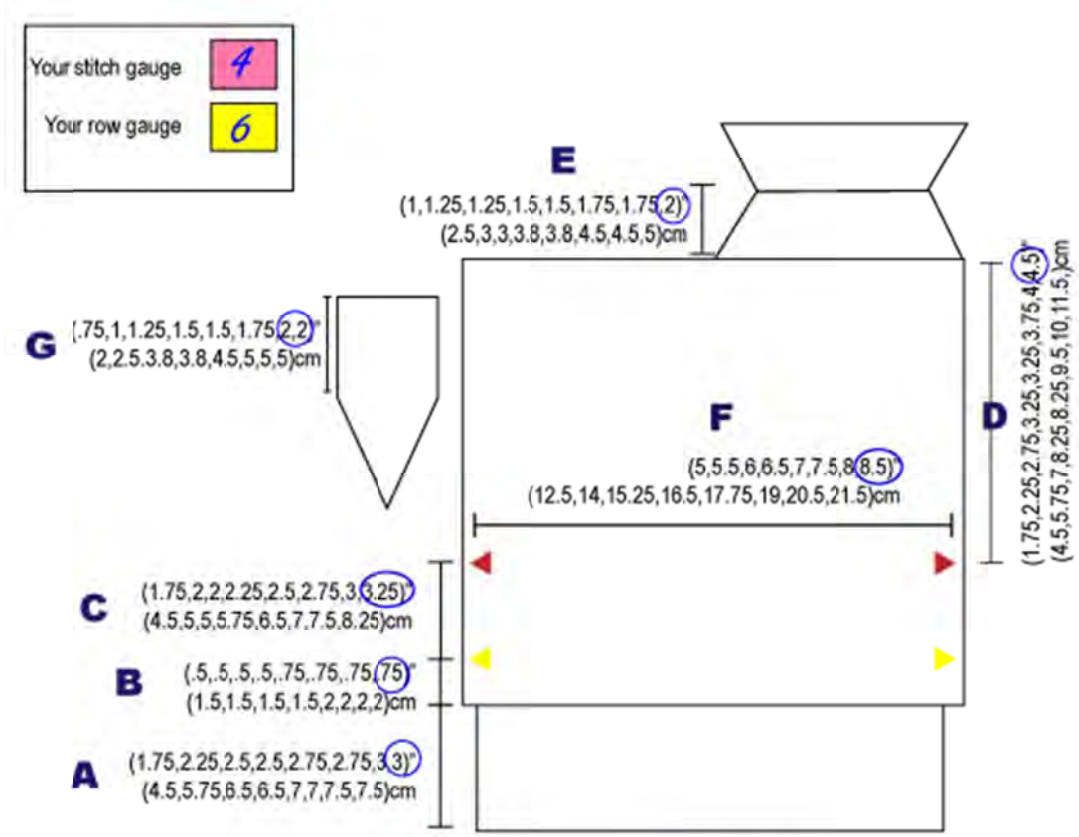
1/2 [E x] _____ Times

[G x] _____ Rows

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Circle your size
2. Multiply each area (A-F) by your Stitch and Row gauge
3. Transfer your answers to the Fill-in-the-Blanks pattern page

SAMPLE WORKSHEET



[F x 4] 8.5" x 4= 34 Stitches

[A x 6] 3" x 6= 18 Rows

[B x 6] .75" x 6= 4 Rows

[C x 6] 3.25" x 6= 20 Rows

[D x 6] 4.5" x 6= 28 Rows

1/2 [E x 6] 2" x 6= 12/2 = 6 Times

[G x 6] 2" x 4= 8 Rows

FILL-IN-THE-BLANKS KNITTING PATTERN

Insert and use the numbers from your worksheet to create your pattern

MITTEN

Cast on F _____ stitches.

Rib for A _____ rows.

Change to stockinette* and knit for B _____ rows.

Place Markers in each edge

Knit for C _____ rows.

Place Markers on each edge

Knit for D _____rows.

Place ½ stitches In hold position.

Short Row Decrease:

Decrease 1 stitch each side every other row E _____ times.

Short Row Increase:

Increase 1 stitch each side every other row until all shaping needles are back in working position.

Remove all stitches on waste yarn.

THUMB

Hang thumb opening on the needles.

Hang first stitch of each side (yellow marker) on center needle (double up).

Pick up 2 stitches for every 3 rows between markers (joining mitten edge).

Pick up approximately F _____ stitches.

Put all stitches but the center 3 in hold position.

Knit across center 3 stitches.

Opposite the carriage, put 1 needle into work.

Repeat until all needles are in work.

Knit for G _____ rows.

Break yarn, thread tail through stitches and remove from the machine.

Gather thumb tip stitches and secure.

Seam thumb and mitten edge to finish.

**Use any stitch pattern of your choice. Just be sure to swatch the stitch pattern to obtain an accurate gauge measurement.*

Do you HATE math?

Use the Knit it Now Dynamic Mitten Pattern. Let us do the math!

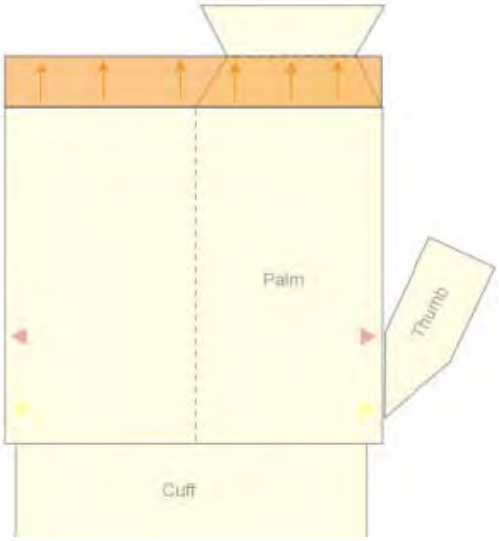
Simply choose your size and enter your stitch and row gauge.

Re-usable for different yarns and sized from babies to adults

www.knititnow.com/mitten

SUPER FAST MITTENS

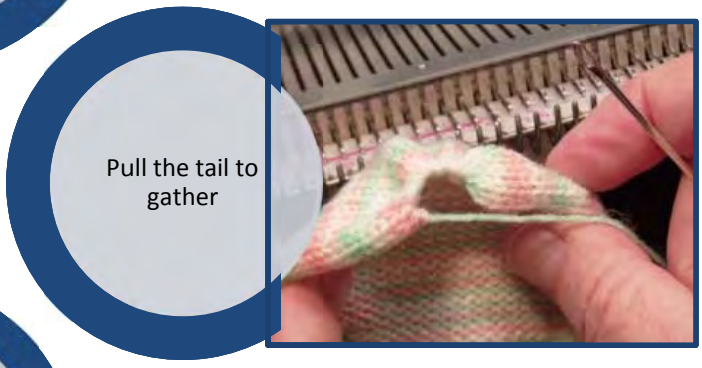
Sometimes you just want to knit a fast mitten, focusing on embellishments (or speed!)



Use the pattern in this book:

1. Don't divide the stitches at the fingertips, knit straight for the "E" dimension (the orange area)
2. (optional) For less bulk, transfer every other needle on the last row and knit 1 row at a tighter tension
3. Break the yarn and use a darning needle or double eye needle to run the tail through all the stitches.





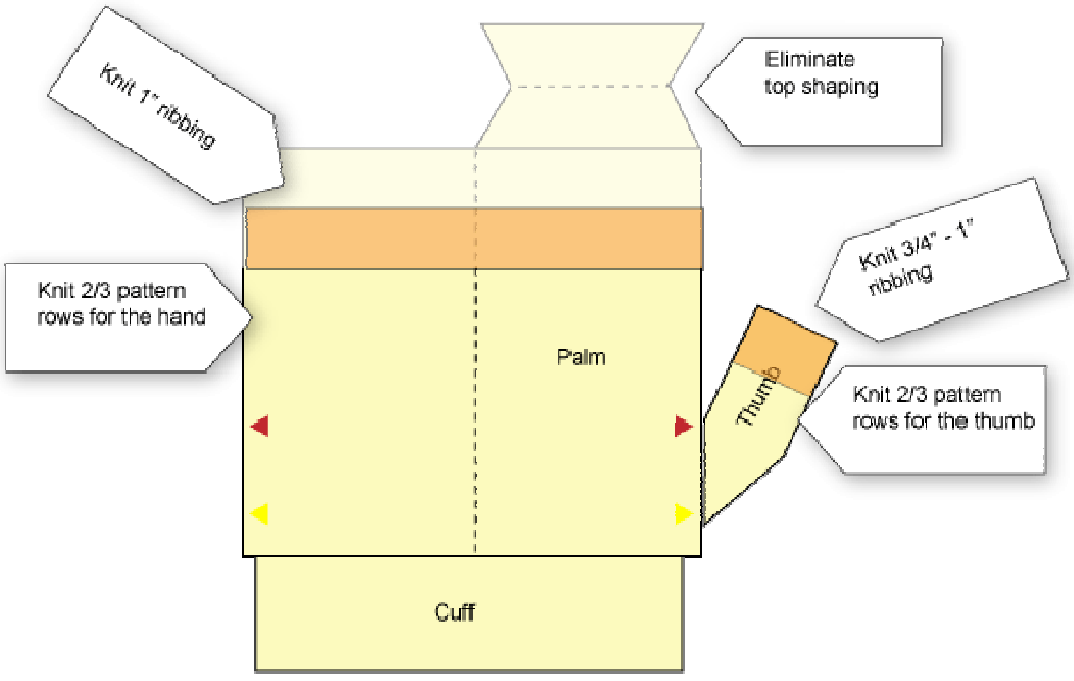


FINGERLESS MITTENS

Eliminate the top shaping and the tip of the thumb for fingerless mittens.

1. Follow your pattern to the hand section
2. Knit approx. 2/3 of the hand “D” stitches
3. Remove from the machine and knit 1” of ribbing
4. Transfer stitches to the ribber and knit 1” of ribbing
5. Bind Off
6. Pick up and shape thumb as instructed
7. Knit desired thumb length less ¾” – 1”
8. Remove from the machine and hand knit ¾”- 1” in ribbing
9. Transfer stitches to the ribber and knit ¾” - 1” ribbing
10. Bind off
11. Sew up side seam





FELTED MITTENS

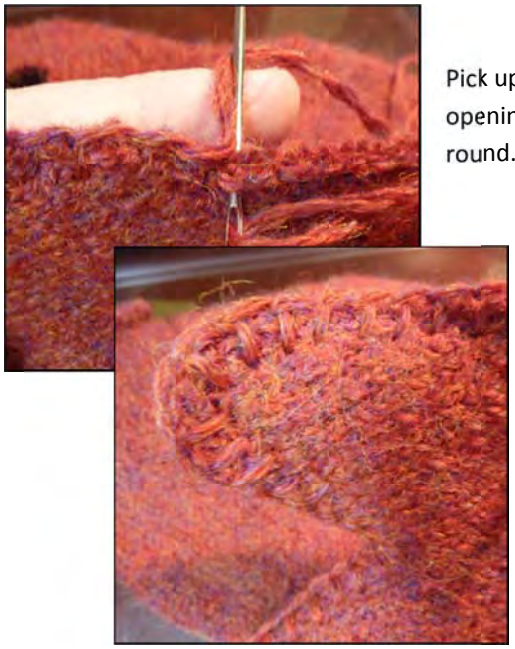
These mittens are fun to make and are very warm.

Machine knitters can knit up wool yardage quickly. Include sewing friends in a project to make mittens for your community.



- Knit up yardage with 100% wool yarn of any weight. Our sample used a 2/8 Jaggerspun Heather (Tension 9 on a standard machine).
- Lightly felt the yardage (not too much, you don't want the mittens to be stiff).
- Place 2 layers together.
- Use the Knit it Now Mitten Template to draw the shape on the felted knitting.
- Use your sewing machine and sew on the marked outline to form the hand of the mitten
- Cut out the mitten leaving a small seam
- Use blanket stitch to embellish and add a little embellishment (or a lot)
- Add hand knitted ribbing by picking up stitches around the wrist opening
- Be creative!

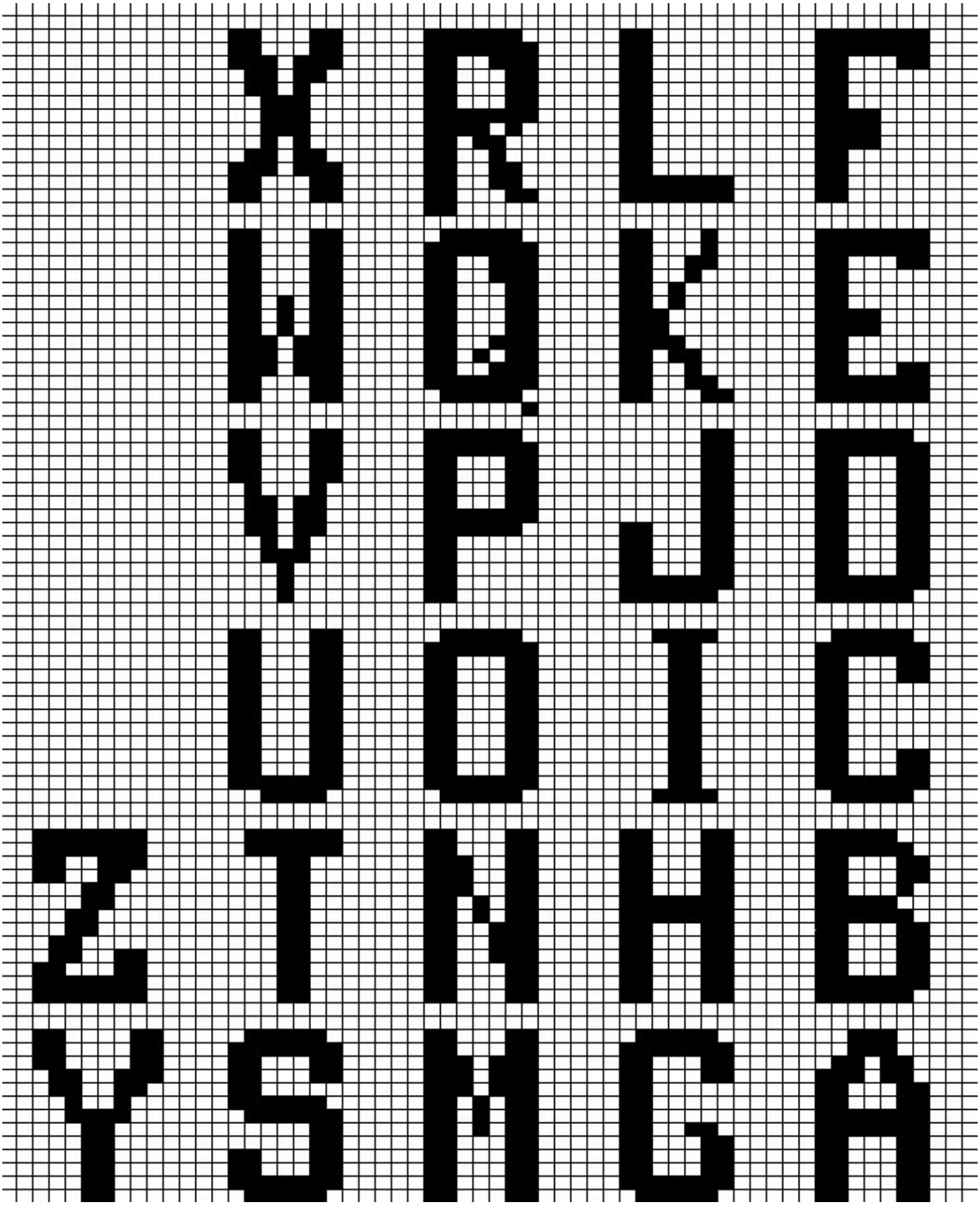


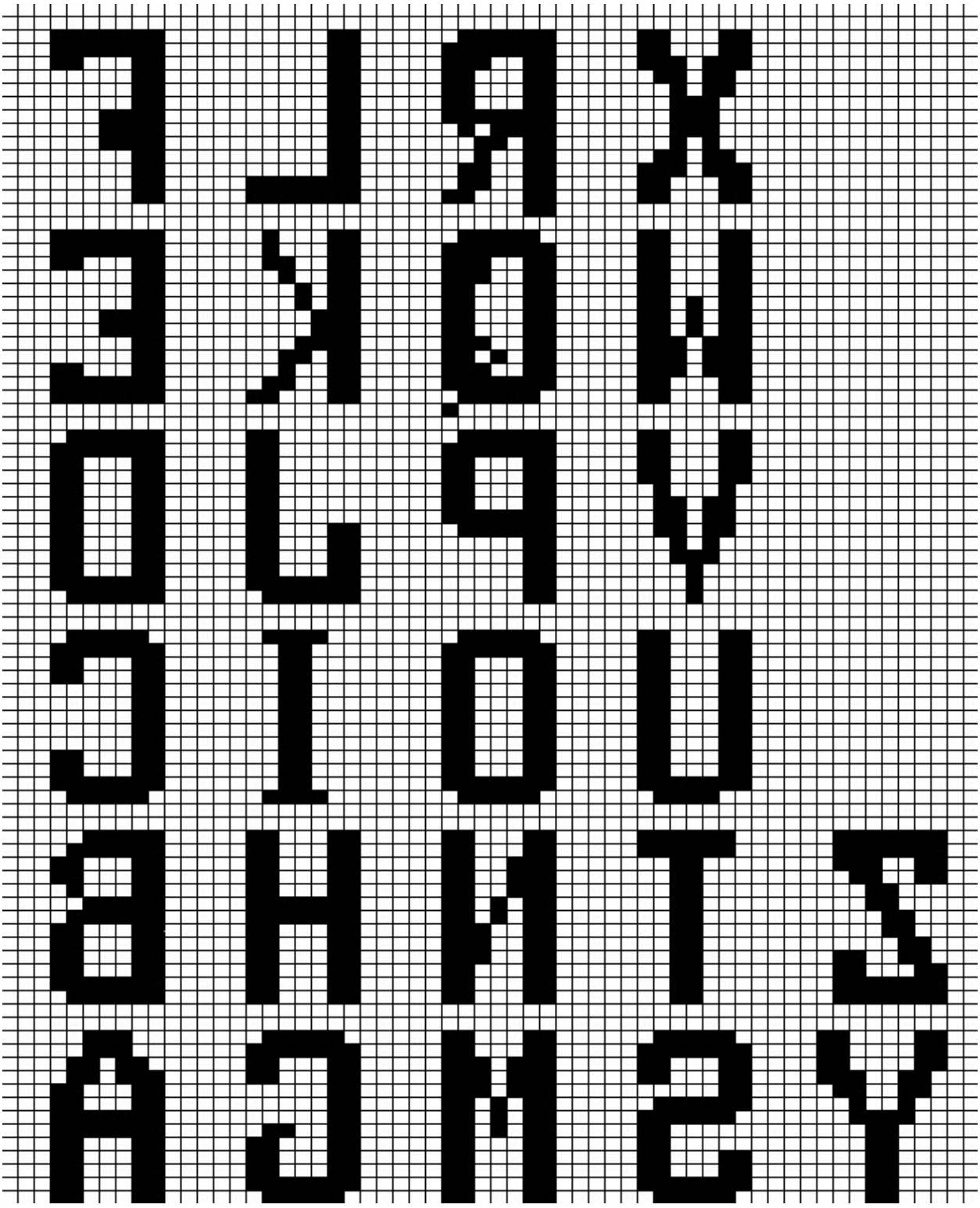


Pick up stitches from the wrist opening and hand knit cuffs in the round.

Work decorative blanket stitch around the edges. Use a contrasting color for a fun accent – Embroidery thread comes in lots of colors and works great!

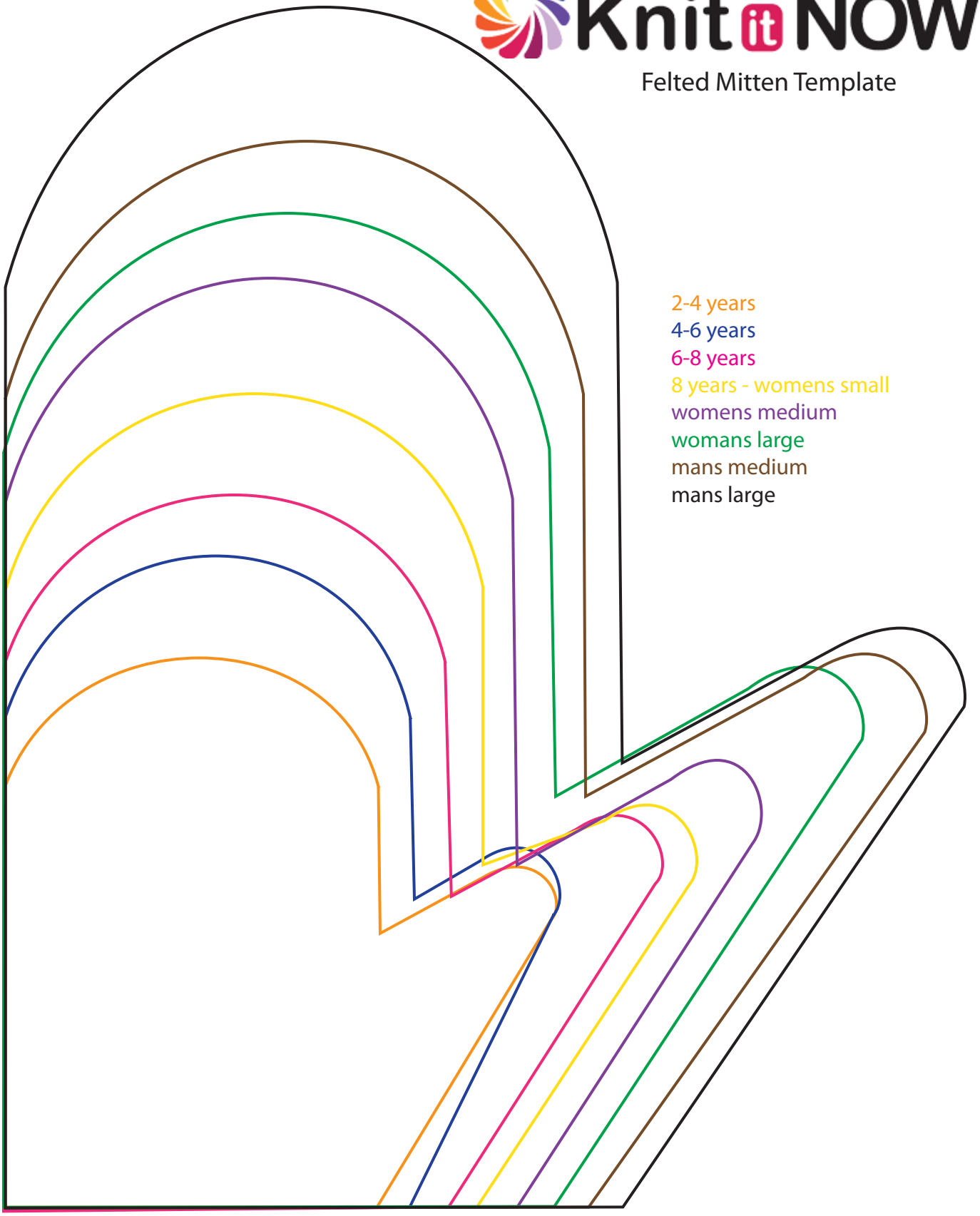
Used at a gauge of approx. 7 stitches per inch , each letter is approx. 1” wide

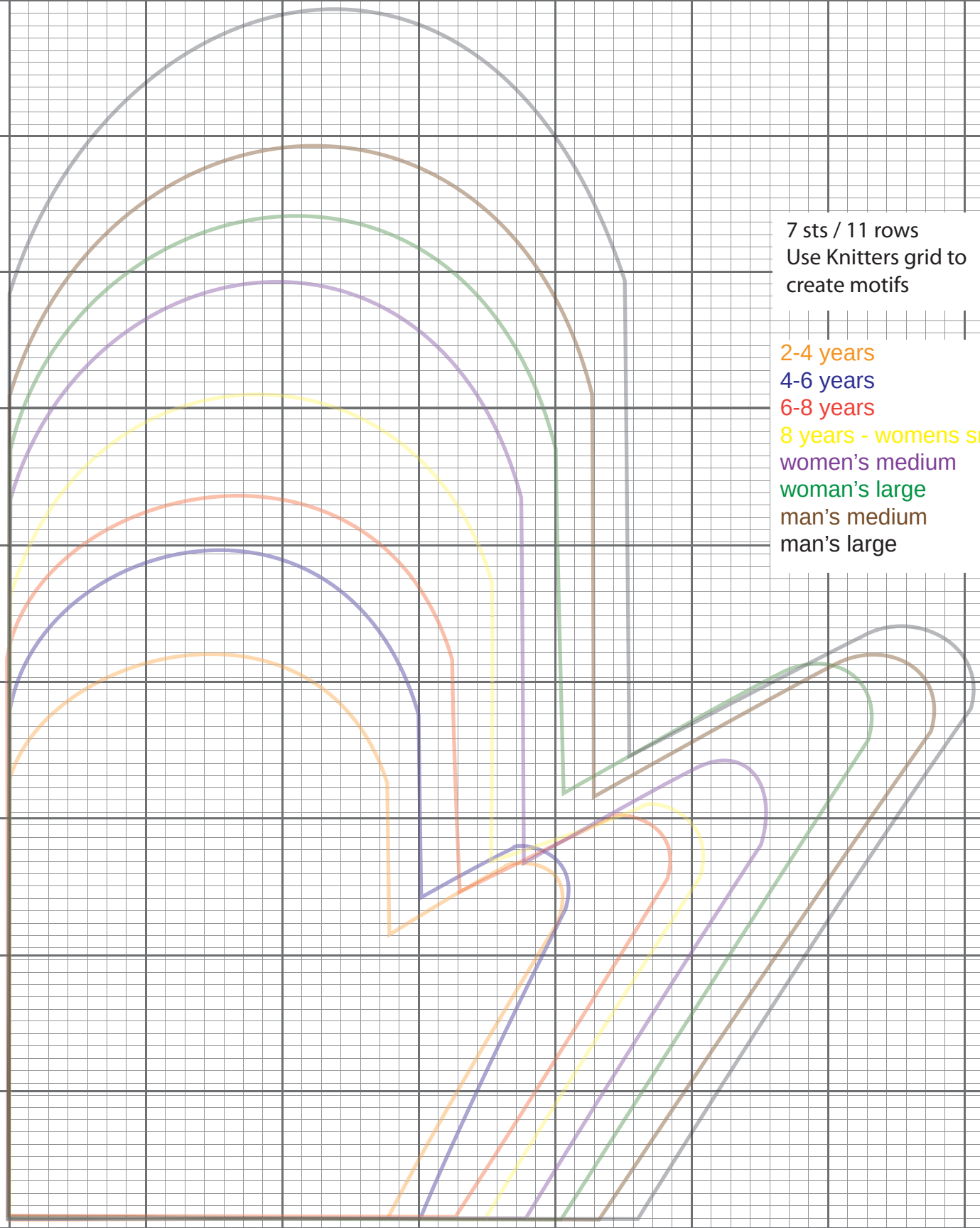




Knit it NOW

Felted Mitten Template

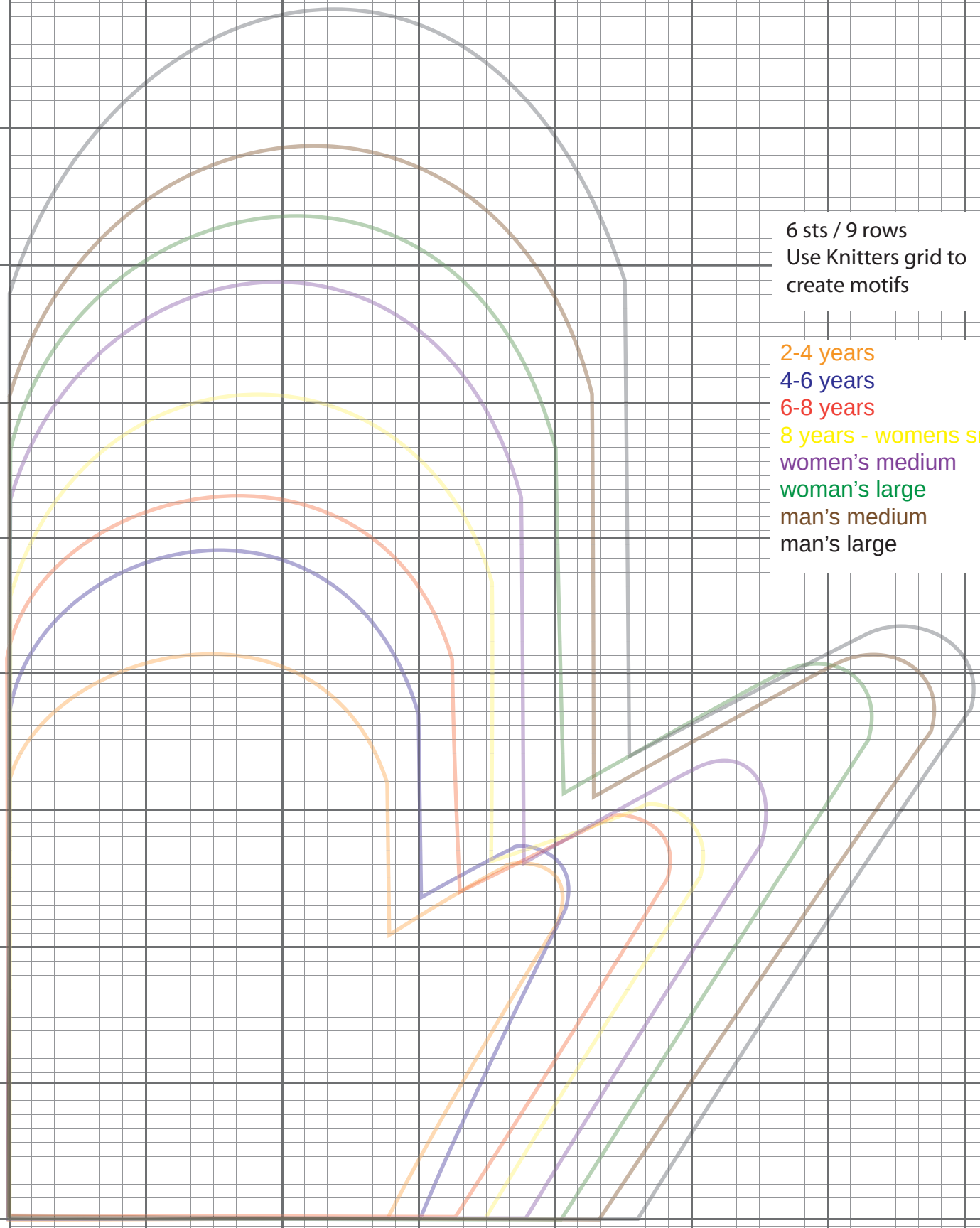




7 sts / 11 rows
Use Knitters grid to create motifs

2-4 years
4-6 years
6-8 years
8 years - womens small
women's medium
woman's large
man's medium
man's large

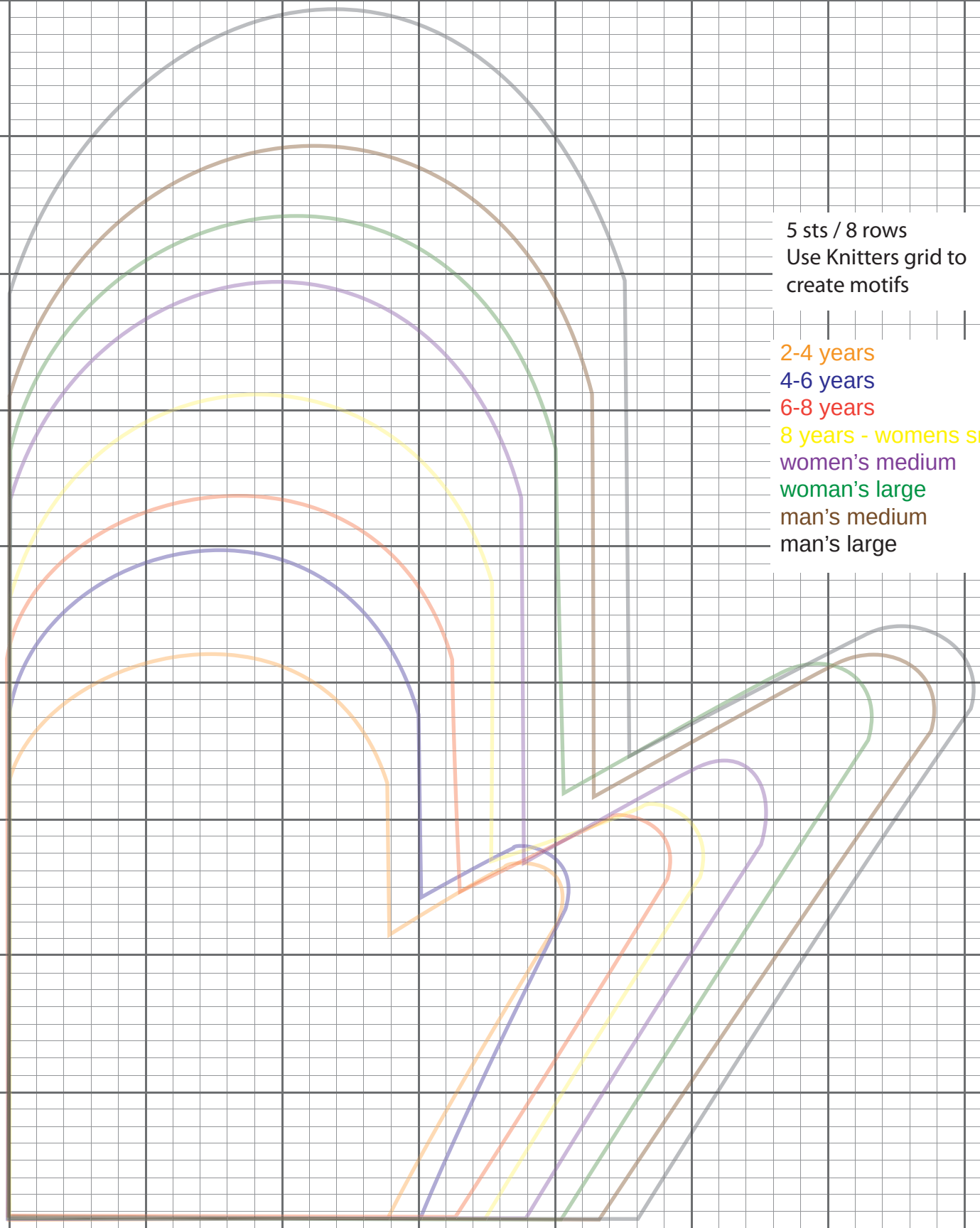
Knit it NOW
Helping you be a better machine knitter



6 sts / 9 rows
Use Knitters grid to create motifs

2-4 years
4-6 years
6-8 years
8 years - womens small
women's medium
woman's large
man's medium
man's large

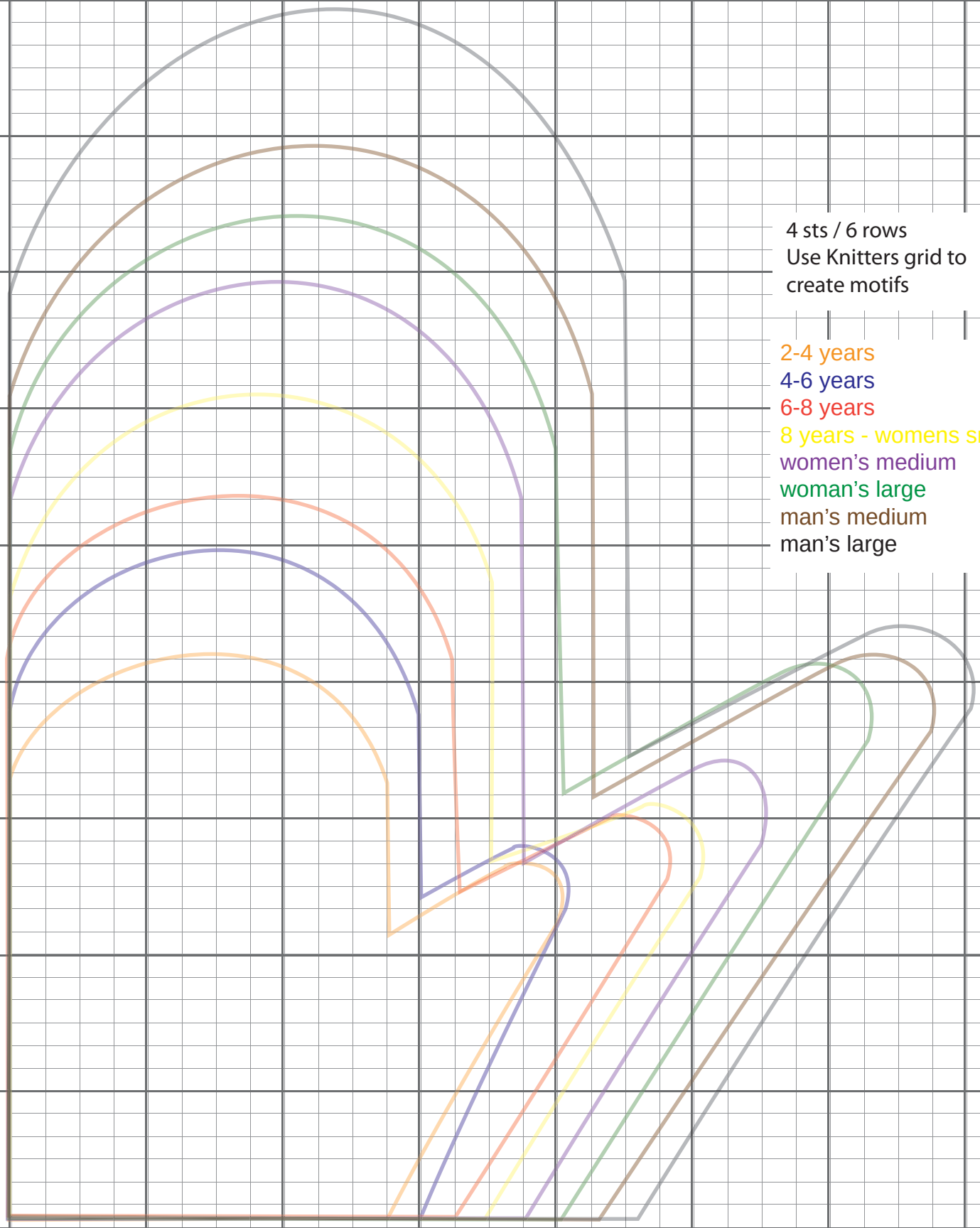
Knit it NOW
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5 sts / 8 rows
Use Knitters grid to create motifs

2-4 years
4-6 years
6-8 years
8 years - womens small
women's medium
woman's large
man's medium
man's large

Knit it NOW
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4 sts / 6 rows
Use Knitters grid to create motifs

2-4 years
4-6 years
6-8 years
8 years - womens small
women's medium
woman's large
man's medium
man's large

Knit it NOW
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